

DELTA TEACHING EVALUATION LEARNING COMMUNITY



University of Georgia

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DeLTA Teaching Evaluation Learning
Community

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DeLTA LibreTexts Page



DeLTA is a team of UGA faculty and administrators who work collaboratively to make teaching evaluation more useful for faculty, students, and departments. This project has received grant support from the [National Science Foundation](#) and the Howard Hughes Medical Institute. DeLTA works with faculty, departments, and institutional governance to advance best practices for teaching evaluation.

DeLTA works side-by-side with departments as they consider how to shift their teaching evaluation practices to better meet their needs. DeLTA works with department heads in the [Leadership Action Team \(LAT\)](#) over the course of a year to learn about robust and equitable teaching evaluation practices and to endorse the adoption of new practices in their departments. DeLTA also works with faculty advocates in the [Catalyzing Action Team \(CAT\)](#). These faculty leaders are identified by their department head due to their interests and expertise. The CAT meets with facilitators biweekly for a year to learn about robust and equitable teaching evaluation, adapt and build new department practices, and pilot these practices, in consultation with their department chair. The faculty advocates also work alongside the department chair to cultivate faculty buy-in. The outcomes of the LAT and CAT include shifts in thinking about teaching evaluation and concrete plans for new departmental practices that move beyond sole reliance on student evaluations. These new practices may involve teaching self-reflection, peer observation of teaching, and new approaches to gathering or using student evaluation data.

The goal of this LibreTexts is to share resources with CAT and LAT members within UGA and with partners at other institutions implementing a similar approach.

[Catalyzing Action Team Page](#)

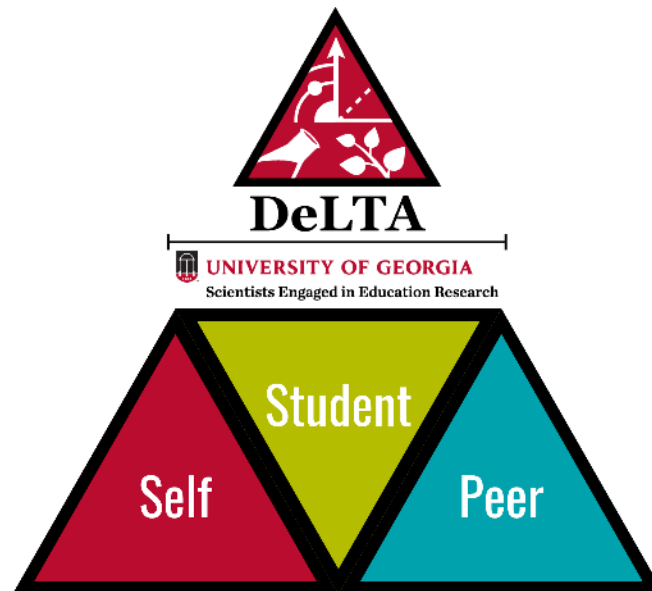
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1.2: The Three-Voice Framework

The Three-Voice Framework

While engaging in the DeLTA project, CAT and LAT members will learn, build, and pilot evidence-based teaching evaluation practices that involve collecting feedback from multiple sources: the instructor (self), trained peers, and students. Instead of relying solely on student end-of-course evaluations, this robust and equitable approach—termed the “three voices” (Andrews et al., 2020; TEval, 2019)—creates a holistic picture of teaching effectiveness and improvement (Reinholz et al., 2019).



Self Voice

Instructors are well-suited to provide evidence for their teaching goals, intentions, and efforts to learn and improve their practices. Through a process of self-reflection (Weaver et al., 2020), instructors are positioned to describe their teaching accomplishments, strengths, opportunities for improvement, and any changes they made to their practices based on experiences such as professional development activities and formative assessment efforts. Instructors can also synthesize and contextualize evidence from the student and peer voices regarding their overall teaching effectiveness (Krishnan et al., 2022).

Peer Voice

Trained peers are well-suited to provide evidence about an instructor’s teaching through teaching observations and review of teaching materials (Weaver et al., 2020). Peers consist of other instructors that have relevant expertise in the instructor’s discipline and teaching experience of their own, allowing them to contribute more constructive feedback compared to students (Thomas et al., 2014). When trained on evidence-based practices for conducting peer observations, peers can evaluate how well the instructor’s course content and skills align with the discipline and gauge the effectiveness of their teaching strategies (Thomas et al., 2014).

Student Voice

Students are well-suited to provide evidence on their day-to-day experiences in the course and the accessibility of the instructor (Krishnan et al., 2022). While students can provide information through end-of-course evaluations, their voice can also be reflected through mid-semester evaluations, pre- and post-assessments, and student interviews (Weaver et al., 2020).

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1.3: Catalyzing Action Team (CAT)

DeLTA Catalyzing Action Team (CAT)

Developed as an NSF-DeLTA funded project, Catalyzing Action Team (CAT) learning communities consist of faculty leaders from participating departments who wish to devote time learning about robust and equitable teaching evaluation, building new departmental evaluation practices, and piloting and refining these practices. Members collaborate in a Learn-Build-Pilot sequence, learning first and then building and piloting new departmental teaching evaluation practices based on the [Three-Voice Framework](#). This curriculum draws heavily on social cognition and cultural change perspectives and the readiness for change framework. CAT members are empowered and supported by their respective department chairs in the pursuit of teaching evaluation reform and work in tandem with the [Leadership Action Team \(LAT\)](#). CAT members attend bi-weekly meetings during one academic year facilitated by DeLTA and are compensated with summer salary.



GOAL:

Learn about robust and equitable teaching evaluation & leading change, and build and pilot new departmental practices.



WHO:

1-3 faculty per department, identified, empowered, and supported by Department Chair. Compensated with summer salary.



HOW:

Bi-weekly facilitated meetings for an academic year & work outside of meetings.

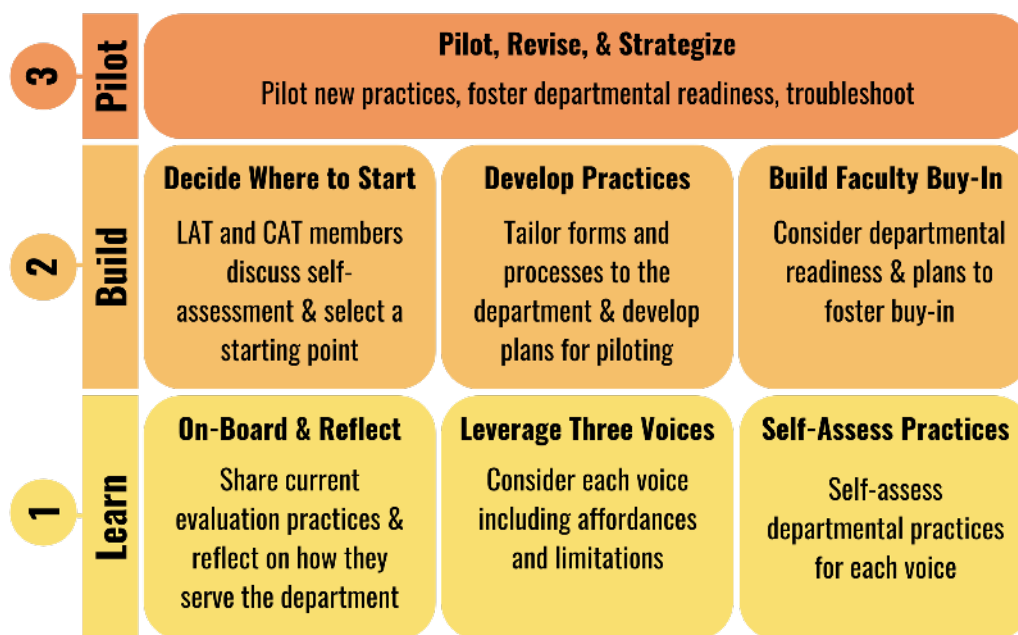
Department chairs identify 1-2 faculty members for the CAT who are interested, able to commit the necessary time for this work, and well positioned to advocate for change. Chairs give CAT members power and support to share their work with their department and pilot new practices. Chairs also commit to endorsing these practices so that they become institutionalized for the full department. The CAT members from across departments form a single team that collaborates to take action. Though each CAT member spearheads practices for their own department, the team provides an essential collaborative environment for sharing ideas across departments and disciplines, troubleshooting, and fostering the resilience needed for persisting in departmental change. Ideally, members meet bi-weekly over 1 year, with 1-2 facilitators from the change agent team.

Learn - Build - Pilot

DeLTA uses the Learn-Build-Pilot sequence to guide CAT members through the process of reforming teaching evaluation within their respective departments. The CAT commences in the fall semester, with four bi-weekly meetings in the Learn phase. Then, in the spring semester the CAT collaborates with their department chairs to engage in the Build phase together, which lasts through the summer. The Build phase consists of two 1-on-1 meetings between chairs and CAT members of a department. The Pilot phase occurs in the second fall semester and includes feedback from department members. CAT members are expected to do the following during their academic year of action:

- Attend a summer meeting with their department chair

- Attend CAT meetings every other week
- Attend joint monthly meetings with LAT members
- Develop, enact, and share new teaching evaluation processes and tools in their department
- Share progress with colleagues in similar roles in other departments
- Advocate within their department
- Participate in ongoing DeLTA research & evaluation
- Continue the work in year 2 with sufficient progress in year 1



Time progresses from bottom (Learn) to top (Pilot) and left to right.

Learn

This stage is critical because STEM faculty have typically had few opportunities to learn about or experience evidence-based, improvement-oriented, and equity-centered teaching evaluation practices. Our preliminary work has revealed the productive ideas (e.g., teaching evaluation is most important for helping faculty improve their teaching) and the unproductive ones (e.g., peer evaluation is too time-consuming and biased) that faculty hold regarding teaching evaluation and departmental change. As a result, we are prepared to elicit and respond to these ideas using questions and activities that effectively foster learning. We will provide scaffolded learning opportunities that build CAT members' expertise about teaching evaluation and leading change, drawing on the readiness for change framework. We will create a sense of discrepancy by introducing CAT members to data about the shortcomings of current practices and probing them to reflect on current departmental practices. This will involve the GATEs (Krishnan et al., 2022), which can help faculty see problems in their current approaches (i.e., discrepancy), and provide feasible and effective solutions to identified problems (i.e., appropriateness & valence). We will foster confidence in their capability to change departmental practices (i.e., efficacy) by providing leadership training about fostering faculty buy-in and navigating resistance. For example, we will introduce the readiness for change framework as a guide for conveying messages to faculty that foster buy-in (e.g., Armenakis & Harris, 2002). We will increase a sense of administrative support for reforms by keeping LAT and CAT members informed about relevant university-level policies.

Build

After reflecting on their current practices and learning about more robust and equitable practices, the next step is building new departmental practices. We support CAT members in adapting existing forms and processes to fit the needs of their department. For example, there are numerous peer observation forms and instructor self-reflection templates that have already been refined by other departments, both within the DeLTA project and beyond. We have previously curated a collection of forms and processes for student, peer, and self voice, as a supplemental material in Krishnan et al. (2022) and in the [UGA teaching evaluation website](#) that we built.

Alongside building teaching evaluation practices, we also support LAT and CAT members to plan how they will build readiness for teaching evaluation reform in their department. We facilitate discussions that prompt LAT and CAT members to identify the various problems that can be addressed by new teaching evaluation practices. Leaders will be more successful at fostering readiness for change if they can identify what others see as important problems and speak to how the change can help address those problems (Armenakis & Harris, 2002). For example, while LAT or CAT members may see a need to better recognize good teaching in the department, other faculty may be more concerned about the importance of mentoring junior faculty. These faculty may be open to formative teaching evaluation that helps faculty improve their teaching.

Pilot

The last phase in the DeLTA model is piloting new departmental teaching evaluation practices. This stage allows for refining new practices and fostering readiness for change among departmental faculty. The LAT member will sanction the pilot and help roll out new practices in a way that recruits supporters and minimizes resistance. CAT members will lead the pilot and revise the practices based on their experiences and feedback from colleagues. Another component of the pilot phase may be faculty meetings about teaching evaluation, which the DeLTA team can support at the request of CAT and LAT members. These meetings may aim to raise awareness, facilitate consensus-building about new practices, or foster skill building (e.g., skills for systematic self-reflection, providing high-quality feedback, conducting peer observation). The DeLTA team will collaborate with CAT and LAT members to determine what support they need to foster buy-in for new practices and to support faculty member's productive engagement with new practices. CAT meetings in this phase respond to members' needs and include troubleshooting, returning to topics from the learning phase as needed, providing feedback, interpreting feedback from colleagues about the pilot, and making plans for next steps.

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1.4: Leadership Action Team (LAT)

DeLTA Leadership Action Team (LAT)

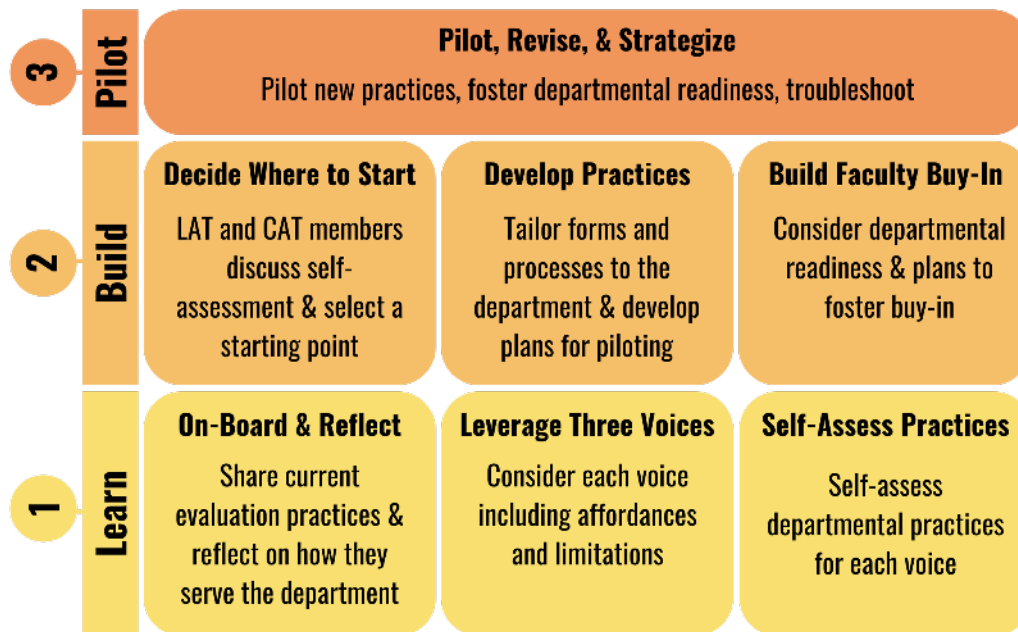
The Leadership Action Team (LAT) is one of two key pieces of the NSF-funded DeLTA model. It consists of department chairs from participating departments who meet about seven times in an academic year to learn about robust and equitable teaching evaluation, building new departmental evaluation practices, and piloting and refining these practices. Members collaborate in a Learn-Build-Pilot sequence, learning first and then building and piloting new departmental teaching evaluation practices based on the [Three-Voice Framework](#). This curriculum draws heavily on social cognition and cultural change perspectives and the readiness for change framework. LAT members work in tandem with the [Catalyzing Action Team \(CAT\)](#) advocate(s) from their department to develop and enact new departmental teaching evaluation practices.

The DeLTA project leaders identify candidate departments for participation in the LAT/CAT model. This happens as we learn about department chairs or faculty who are keen to improve their practices or who have been showing up at teaching evaluation workshops or who are known to embrace new ideas and transformative change. Project leaders hold an initial meeting with each candidate department chair to explain the project, the rationale behind it, what can be gained, and what the commitment involves. We explain that participation involves committed participation by both the department chair for the LAT and 1-2 faculty members for the CAT.

Learn - Build - Pilot

DeLTA uses the Learn-Build-Pilot sequence to guide LAT members through the process of reforming teaching evaluation within their respective departments. The LAT, along with the CAT, commences in the fall semester and continues into the spring semester. They meet monthly (5 meetings) in the fall and twice in the spring. The Build phase consists of two 1-on-1 meetings between each LAT member and their CAT members. The Pilot phase occurs in the second fall semester and is led by CAT members but enabled and empowered by the LAT member. LAT members are expected to do the following during their academic year of action:

- Participate in the Leadership Action Team with other department chairs
- Give your departmental advocate (CAT) the power and support to share their work with the department and enact new departmental practices
- Promote new teaching evaluation practices so they become standard practice for the full department
- Focus department on evidence from all three voices - Teaching evaluation focus (3-Voices) supported by CAT work
- Identify leadership skills needed to support LAT
- Identify potential challenges from department



Time progresses from bottom (Learn) to top (Pilot) and left to right.

Learn

This stage is critical because STEM department chairs have typically had few opportunities to learn about or experience evidence-based, improvement-oriented, and equity-centered teaching evaluation practices. Our work has revealed the productive ideas (e.g., teaching evaluation is most important for helping faculty improve their teaching) and the unproductive ones (e.g., peer evaluation is too time-consuming and biased) that department chairs hold regarding teaching evaluation and departmental change. As a result, LAT facilitators are prepared to elicit and respond to these ideas using questions and activities that effectively foster learning. We provide scaffolded learning opportunities that build LAT members' expertise about teaching evaluation and leading change, drawing on the readiness for change framework. We create a sense of discrepancy by introducing LAT members to data about the shortcomings of current practices and probing them to reflect on current departmental practices. This involves the GATES (Krishnan et al., 2022), which can help faculty see problems in their current approaches (i.e., discrepancy), and provide feasible and effective solutions to identified problems (i.e., appropriateness & valence). We foster confidence in department chairs' capability to change departmental practices (i.e., efficacy) by providing leadership training about fostering faculty buy-in and navigating resistance. For example, we introduce the readiness for change framework as a guide for conveying messages to faculty that foster buy-in (e.g., Armenakis & Harris, 2002). We increase a sense of administrative support for reforms by keeping LAT members informed about relevant university-level policies.

Build

After learning about new frameworks and processes for evaluating teaching and reflecting on their department's current practices, the next step is building new departmental practices. LAT members work with CAT members on this part. Each LAT member and their CAT members meet late in the first fall semester to determine what should change in the department. We encourage them to sequence their work, so that they are not taking on everything at once. Together they decided on the best first steps, next steps, etc. Concurrently the CAT members are being supported by CAT facilitators to adapt existing forms and processes to fit the needs of their department. For example, if a LAT member and CAT members decide to develop new peer observation processes, the CAT members work with their CAT facilitators to identify and adapt one of the numerous peer observation forms that have already been

refined by other departments, both within the DeLTA project and beyond. See the [Catalyzing Action Team \(CAT\)](#) page for more details.

Alongside building teaching evaluation practices, we also support LAT and CAT members to plan how they will build readiness for teaching evaluation reform in their department. We facilitate discussions that prompt LAT and CAT members to identify the various problems that can be addressed by new teaching evaluation practices. Leaders will be more successful at fostering readiness for change if they can identify what others see as important problems and speak to how the change can help address those problems (Armenakis & Harris, 2002). For example, while LAT or CAT members may see a need to better recognize good teaching in the department, other faculty may be more concerned about the importance of mentoring junior faculty. These faculty may be open to formative teaching evaluation that helps faculty improve their teaching.

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1.5: Curriculum for Fall 2024

Date	CAT	LAT
August	Onboarding and reflecting on teaching eval practices <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 8/26, Tues 8/27, Wed 8/28</i>	Onboarding and reflecting on teaching eval practices <i>Meeting Date: Mon 8/26</i>
September	Three voices framework for teaching evaluation <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 9/9, Tues 9/10, Wed 9/11</i>	Three voices framework for teaching evaluation <i>Meeting Date: Mon 9/16</i>
September	Self-assessment of departmental teaching evaluation practices (GATES) <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 9/23, Tues 9/24, Wed 9/25</i>	
October	Leadership development - building buy-in for new dept teaching practices <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 10/7, Tues 10/8, Wed 10/9</i>	Self-assessment of departmental teaching evaluation practices (GATES), peer voice <i>Meeting Date: Fri 10/18</i>
October	Developing new practices, e.g., peer observation <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 10/21, Tues 10/22, Wed 10/23</i>	
November	1-on-1 meeting between Heads & CAT members for each unit <i>This week is free-time to meet with department heads, no CAT meetings!</i>	Self-assessment of departmental teaching evaluation practices (GATES), student and self voice <i>Meeting Date: Fri 11/15</i>
November	Developing new practices, e.g., instructor self-reflection <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 11/18, Tues 11/19, Wed 11/20</i>	
December	Planning for pilot testing new practices <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 12/2, Tues 12/3, Wed 12/4</i>	Building buy-in for new dept teaching practices <i>Meeting Date: Wed 12/11</i>

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November	Developing new practices, e.g., instructor self-reflection <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 11/18, Tues 11/19, Wed 11/20</i>	
December	Planning for pilot testing new practices <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 12/2, Tues 12/3, Wed 12/4</i>	Building buy-in for new dept teaching practices <i>Meeting Date: Wed 12/11</i>

2.1: 1.0 Fall 2024 Meeting Schedule is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

Prepare for Action: Reflecting on Current Teaching Evaluation Practices

Objectives

- Develop collaborative norms for working together.
- Clarify expected outcomes for CAT members.
- Get to know each other and your academic units.
- Exchange information about the needs and challenges in your units when it comes to teaching evaluation.

Presentation Materials

[Prepare for Action Slides](#)



The screenshot shows a Google Slides presentation. The slide content includes:

- Top left: "2024-2025 CAT"
- Center: A large red rectangle with the text "Meeting 1: Prepare for Action" in white.
- Bottom right: Logos for "ie3 inclusive excellence" and "DeLTA UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA".
- Bottom left: "August, 2024"
- Bottom right: "PAGE 01"

Below the slide, the Google Slides interface is visible, showing a navigation bar with a back arrow, a slide number "1", a forward arrow, and a menu icon. To the right of the navigation bar is a "Google Slides" button.

[Link to Slides](#)

[Climate Handout](#)

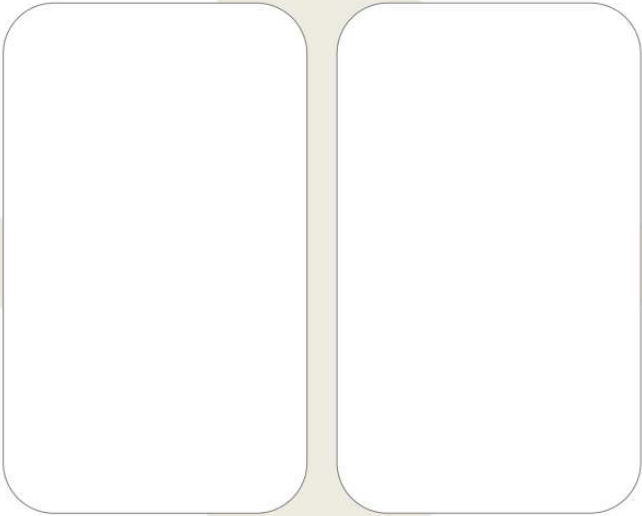


Climate

Reflection: What areas of your department present challenges or opportunities for your work on teaching evaluation policy?

Challenges

Opportunities



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Post-Meeting Assignment

- Reflection of what you learned and are taking away.
- Suggested reading to prepare for Meeting 2:



Issues with Evaluating Teaching

Peer Voice

Peer voice involves gathering data from peers about teaching and learning observable in class. Peer observation often includes:

- Pre-observation meeting to discuss lessons to be observed
- Collection & review of class materials (e.g., syllabi, exams, homework, slides, handouts)
- Observation of lessons
- Post-observation meeting to hear instructor reflections, debrief, and provide feedback

Peer voice can provide feedback and evidence of effectiveness on components that are better assessed by peers than by students, such as appropriateness of course material and course difficulty, alignment with the larger curriculum, and effectiveness of teaching strategies (Berstein 2008; Peel 2005). Studies examining peer review have documented several positive outcomes for faculty involved in the process, including improved self-assurance (Bell and Mladenovic 2008), collegiality and respect (Quinlan and Akerlind 2000), and improved classroom performance (Freiberg 1987). UGA expects departments to establish a peer evaluation process for full-time faculty in order to support teaching improvement over time and document teaching effectiveness fairly and equitably.

Issues with Peer Evaluation

- **Lack of focus on growth:** Peer reviews are often conducted as one-shot events and therefore fail to capture growth and change over time. They also do not provide opportunities for reflection (Peel 2005) or to collaboratively construct solutions with peers (Quinlan and Akerlind 2000) that are needed to achieve changes in teaching quality (Brockbank and McGill 1998).
- **Lack of consistency:** Without preliminary discussion of what effective teaching entails, individual evaluators differ widely in the evaluations and comments that they provide as peer reviewers (Centra, 1975) and tend to base their evaluations on the extent to which the style of the instructor matches their own style (Centra, 2000). A structured approach involving a standard form and observer training can improve consistency and the value of the feedback provided.
- **Concerns about who has the expertise to review:** Faculty may be skeptical of the utility of feedback they might receive from colleagues outside their field (Bell & Mladenovic, 2008). Alternatively, they may feel that colleagues in their department lack pedagogical knowledge to evaluate their teaching.
- **Time:** Faculty may be concerned about expansion of their roles/time expectations for peer review of teaching (Atwood, Taylor, & Hutchings, 2000; Chism, 2007; Kell & Annetts, 2009).
- **Worry that review will be demoralizing:** Faculty are sensitive to receiving constructive feedback, perceiving it as discouraging unless put in perspective (Cosh, 1998; Donnelly, 2007).
- **Evaluators need training:** Several authors have emphasized the need to better train feedback providers (Shortland, 2010), but there are few models for how to provide this training. Faculty feel unprepared to judge the quality of teaching (Cohen & McKeachie, 1980; Kremer, 1990).

Affirm Three Voices

Objectives

- Critically consider the utility and feasibility of evaluating teaching via students, peers, and self-reflection.
- Prepare you for (1) self-assessment of teaching evaluation practices (next meeting) and (2) one-on-one meetings with LAT members (November).

Presentation Materials

Three-Voice Framework Slides



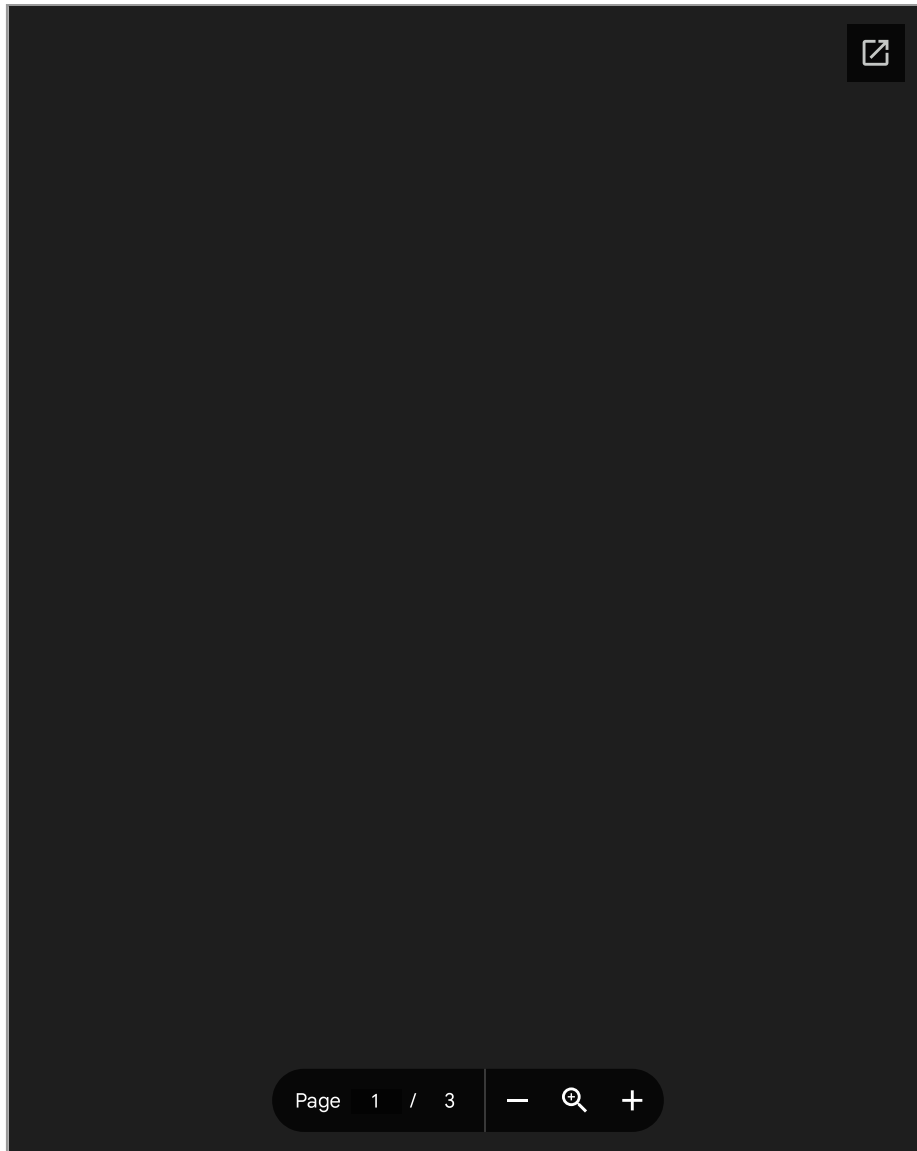
The screenshot shows a Google Slides presentation. The slide content includes:

- Top left: 2024-2025 CAT
- Center: A large red rectangle with the text "Meeting 2: Affirm Three Vo" in white.
- Bottom left: September, 2024
- Bottom right: PAGE 01
- Logos: "ie3 inclusive excellence" and "DeLTA UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA" (with the tagline "commitment to excellence in teaching and learning")

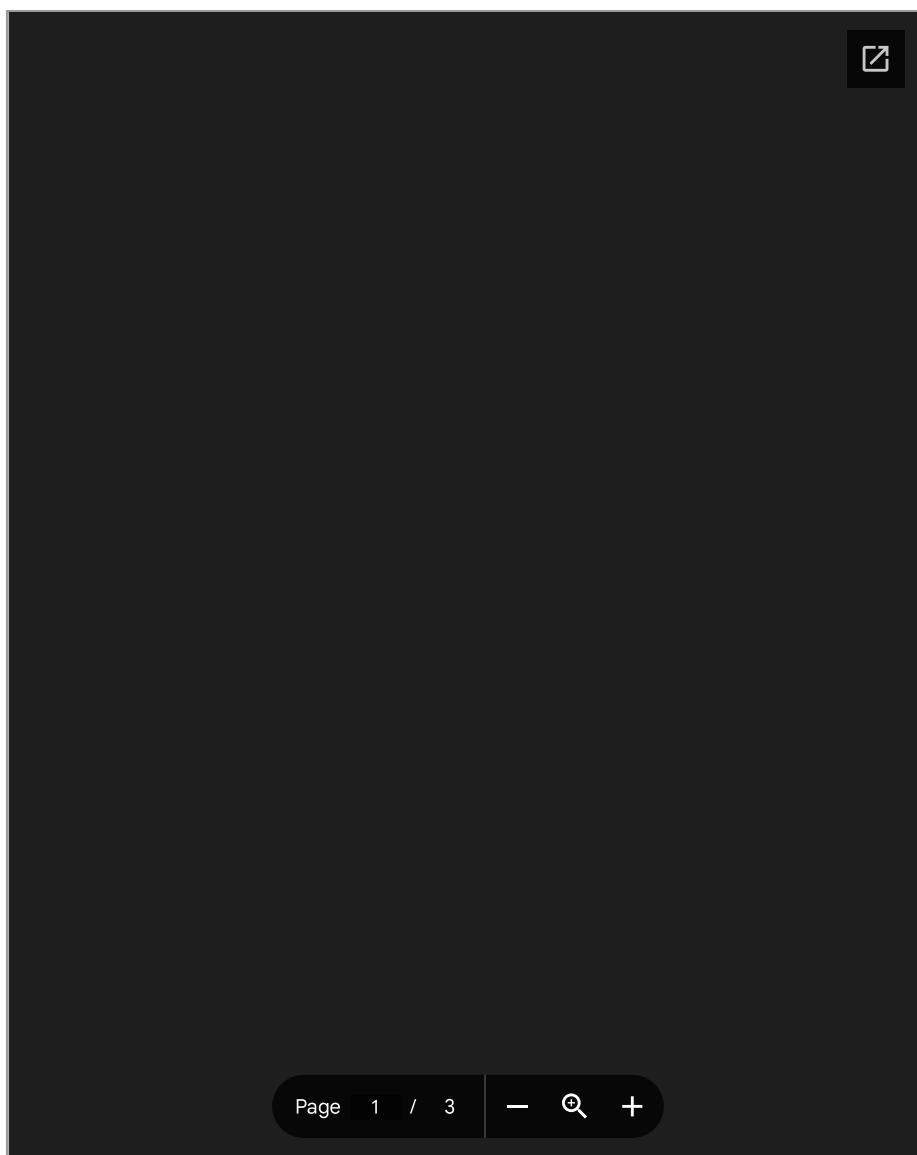
Below the slide, the Google Slides interface is visible, showing a navigation bar with a back arrow, a slide number "1", a forward arrow, and a menu icon. To the right of the navigation bar is a "Google Slides" button.

[Link to Slides](#)

Common Issues with Evaluating Teaching White Paper



Three Voices Affordances and Limitations Handout



Consider each voice using the Three Voices Affordances and Limitations Handout:

- What benefits could using this voice have for faculty? For the department? For students?
- What are the limitations of each voice?
- How would using three voices be different than what your department currently does?
- How could the practices described here support faculty in improving their teaching?

Post-Meeting Assignment

- Before our next meeting, talk to several faculty in your unit about their perceptions of teaching evaluation practices.

2.3: Meeting 2- Affirm Three Voices is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

Assess Current Practices

Objectives

- Introduce the range of robust and equitable teaching evaluation practices for three perspectives (peer, self, and student).
- Self-reflect on where a department is relative to the range of practices.
- Consider and prioritize where a department wishes to develop more robust teaching evaluation processes.

Presentation Materials

[Assess Current Practices Slides](#)

2024-2025 CAT

Meeting 3: Assess Current Practices



September, 2024

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 Google Slides

[Link to Slides](#)

[GATES Electronic](#)



GATES PDF



Post-Meeting Assignment

- None this week!

2.4: Meeting 3- Assess Current Practices is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

Craft a Change Message

Objectives

- Reflect on personal motivation to reform how teaching is evaluated.
- Identify potential concerns that could be raised by colleagues resisting the change efforts.
- Develop convincing arguments to present to department members to argue for change in evaluation practices that mitigate and address those concerns.

Presentation Materials

[Craft a Change Message Slides](#)



The screenshot shows a Google Slides presentation. The slide title is "2024-2025 CAT". The main content area features a large red rectangle with the text "Meeting 4: Crafting a change message" in white. To the right of this rectangle are two logos: "ie3 inclusive excellence" and the "DeLTA UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA" logo. The footer of the slide includes "October, 2024" on the left and "PAGE 01" on the right. The Google Slides interface is visible at the bottom, showing navigation arrows, a "1" in a circle, and a "Google Slides" button.

[Link to Slides](#)

[Crafting a Change Message Handout](#)



Crafting a change message:
Fostering buy-in and allaying concerns
A DeLTA Project Resource

Readiness for change is a cognitive precursor to productive engagement with organizational change. It includes five components (Armenakis et al. 1993; Rafferty et al., 2013).

- **Recognize a problem** (discrepancy): when an individual recognizes that a need for change exists
- **Change addresses the problem** (appropriateness): whether an individual believes that the proposed change adequately addresses the cause of the discrepancy
- **Benefits outweigh the cost** (valence): an individual's evaluation of the benefits and costs of a change
- **We are capable of this** (efficacy): perceived capability of the unit to implement the change being proposed
- **Admin support**: whether the individual believes that the change initiative has sufficient support from the organization. In our context, this may have multiple parts: the dept chair, informal leaders in the dept, and the university/college

Change agents can foster readiness for change in a few ways, including by conveying a **persuasive change message** that addresses the five components of readiness for change. Another important strategy for fostering readiness for change include **active participation**, in which department members participate in the change and learn vicariously from the experiences of others involved in the change. Lastly, change agents can help to **manage information** by involving others in sharing the change message (Armenakis & Harris, 2002).

Your Vision:



How Receptive is Your Department for Implementing Peer Review of Teaching

Rate the extent to which you think these arguments are compelling to your faculty overall.

4 = Especially compelling

3 = Somewhat compelling

2 = Not very compelling

1 = Not at all compelling

Rationale for Peer Review

_____ Professional responsibility argument: As professionals, it is our responsibility to maintain and oversee standards of practice in the work of our colleagues.

_____ Reward argument: Teaching won't be rewarded properly until it is subject to inspection by peers, just as research is. Peer review will raise the status of teaching.

_____ Development of standards argument: Initiating peer review of teaching will result in the articulation of standards of practice, which we have not had before now.

_____ Faculty expectations argument: Having a peer review of teaching program in place will help all faculty to know expectations and get feedback on their performance.

_____ Motivation argument: Making teaching public through subjecting it to peer review will encourage faculty to put more energy into their teaching.

_____ Accountability argument: Peer review of teaching will help satisfy public demands for accountability in higher education.

_____ Mandate argument: Peer review is being mandated across colleges. We have to come up with something we can live with.

_____ Evaluation improvement argument: Thorough evaluation of teaching requires multiple viewpoints (students, peers, self). Our present system of relying mostly on student opinion to judge teaching is unacceptable: Peer review will increase its fairness. Peers are the best source for judging such things as the accuracy and currency of course content.

Total score for strength of rationales: _____

Chism, N. V. N. (2007). *Peer review of teaching: A sourcebook*. Anker Publishing.

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Post-Meeting Assignment

- Use the materials that you create today and create a meeting/lunch/email where you can try out the change message.

2.5: Meeting 4- Craft a Change Message is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

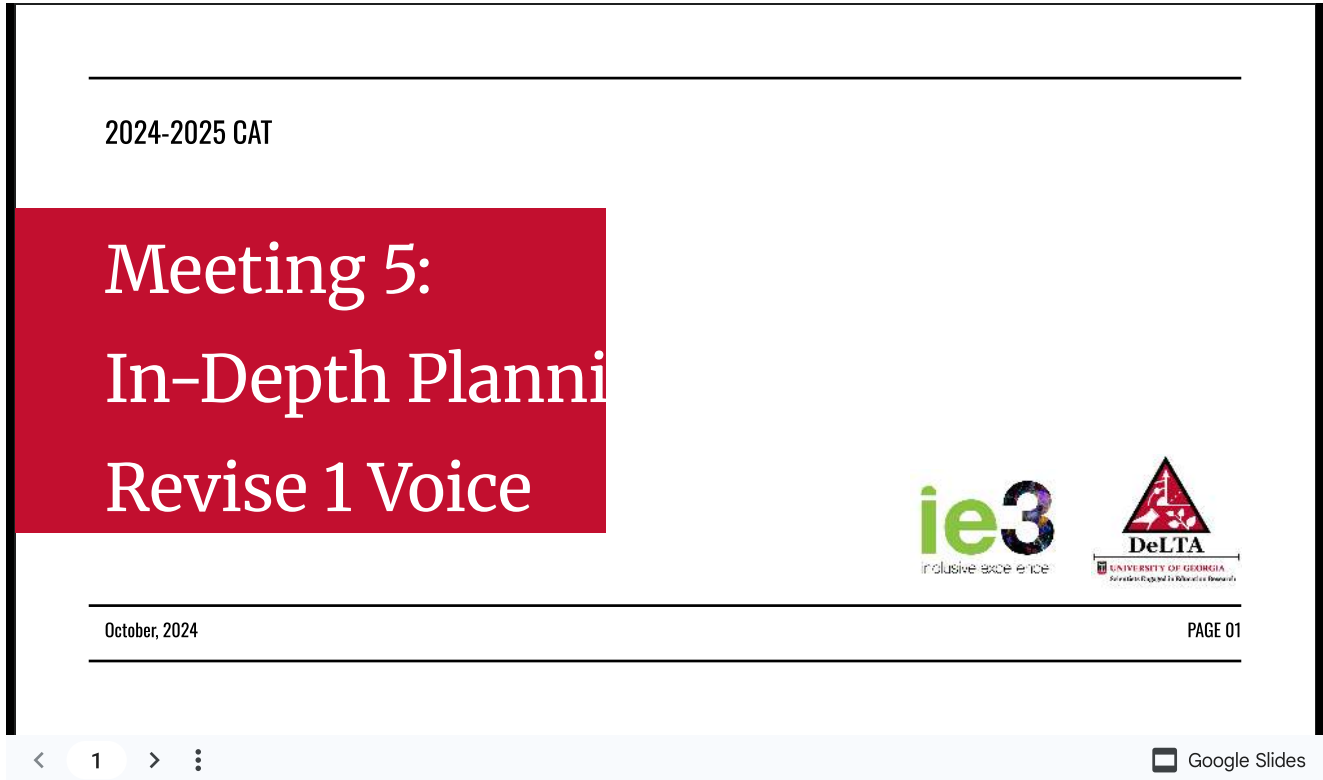
Develop New Practices (Peer, Student, Self) Used to Evaluate Teaching

Objectives

- Articulate the problems that you observe for how teaching is currently evaluated for this perspective in your department.
- Identify areas for improvement in evaluating teaching with this perspective that are desired by faculty and achievable.
- Craft a convincing argument for changing how teaching is evaluated for this perspective that you think will appeal to faculty.

Presentation Materials

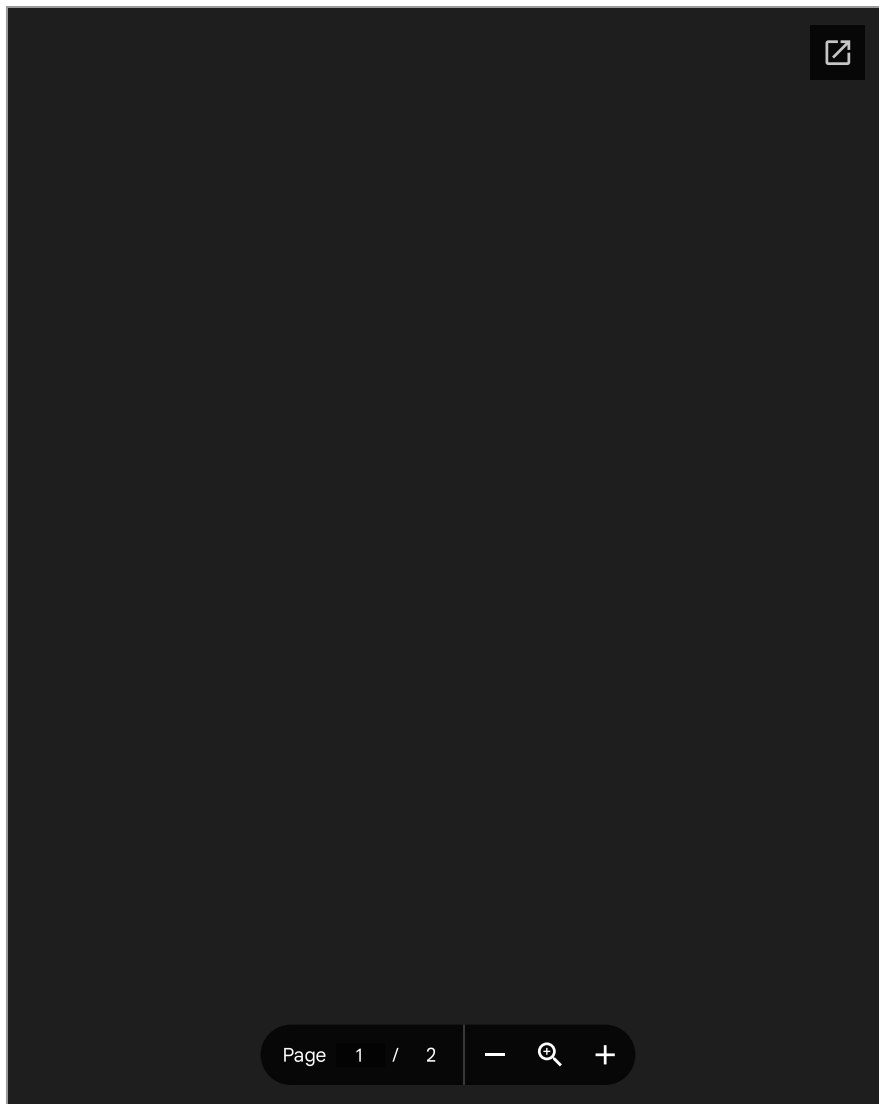
[Develop New Practices Slides](#)



The screenshot shows a Google Slides presentation. The slide title is "2024-2025 CAT". The main content area has a large red box on the left with the text "Meeting 5: In-Depth Planning" and "Revise 1 Voice". To the right of this box are two logos: "ie3 inclusive excellence" and the "DeLTA" logo for the University of Georgia. At the bottom left of the slide is "October, 2024" and at the bottom right is "PAGE 01". The Google Slides interface is visible at the bottom, showing a navigation bar with a back arrow, a slide number "1", a forward arrow, and a menu icon. A "Google Slides" button is also present.

[Link to Slides](#)

[Teaching Evaluation Planning Document](#)



Engaging in Teaching Evaluation from UGA's Center for Teaching and Learning Website



- [Contact Us](#)

[Menu](#)

Error 404 - Page Not Found

Upcoming Events

Apr 23

[Closing Out the Semester with eLC Essentials](#)

11:30 AM - 12:30 PM

Apr 27

[Link to Website](#)

Resources

[Peer Perspective Folder](#)[Student Perspective Folder](#)[Self Perspective Folder](#)

Post-Meeting Assignment

- After your consultation, spend some time drafting up a plan to present to your department head in the next meeting. Include ideas for the members from your department you would like to pull in to collaborate on this (committee members or just one or two partners).

[Submission Folder](#)

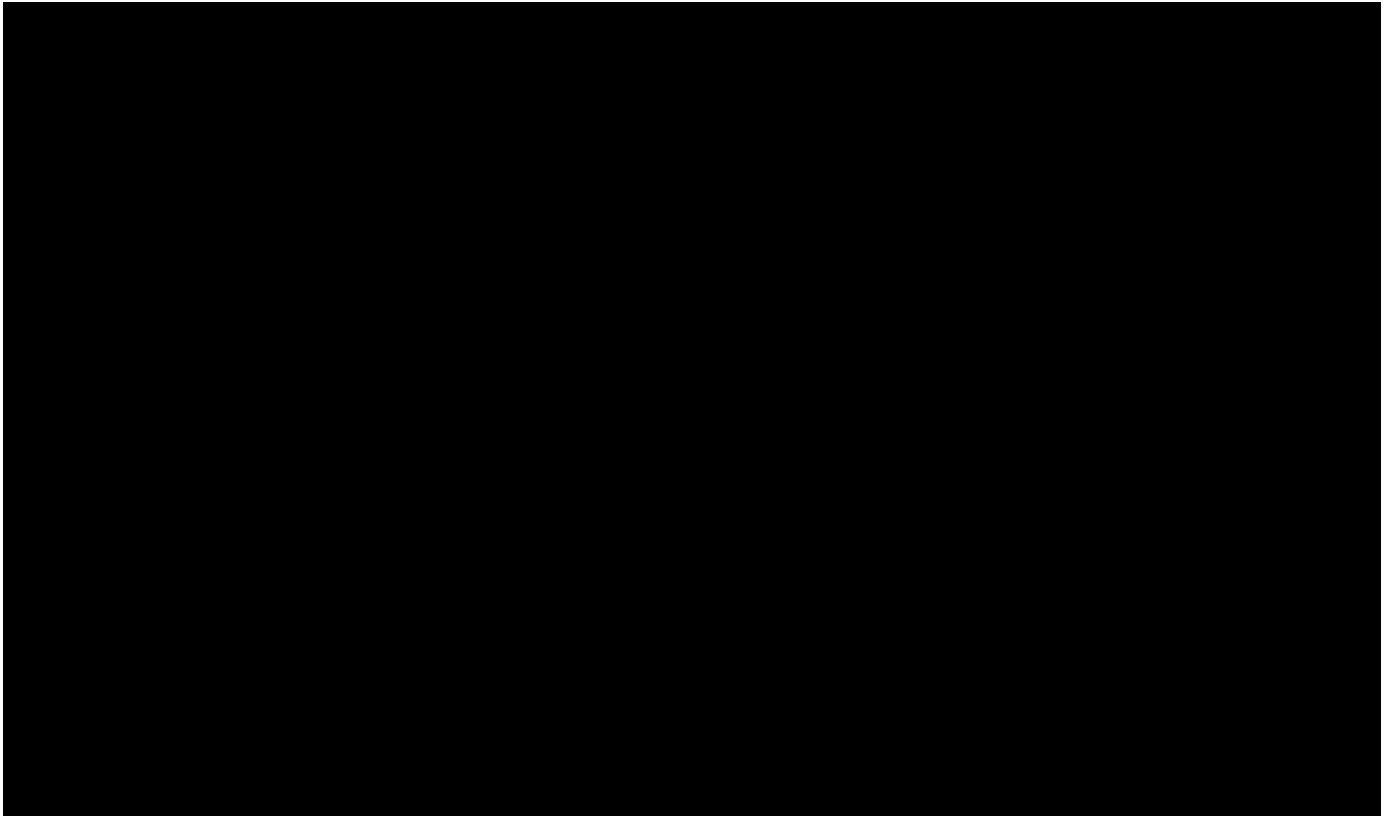
2.6: Meeting 5- Develop New Practices is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

1-on-1 Meetings

Between CAT and Department Chairs

Objectives

- Present the plan you have developed to your department head.
- Organize a summary document to be shared with the group.



Post-Meeting Assignment

- Before our next meeting, provide a summary of your meeting with the department head and briefly describe an overview of your plan and any support materials that you need on this [form](#).

Submission Folder

2.7: Meeting 6- 1-on-1 Meetings Between CAT and Department Chairs is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

Deep Dive Into New Practices

Objectives

- Select one specific perspective that you and your department head have agreed on will make the best next step in improving how teaching is evaluated in your department.
- Review resources developed by other units to identify suitable models.
- Determine your first step (organize materials for colleagues to review, determine a good group of faculty to meet to help review materials, schedule a meeting time, draft email to these folks, or to the whole department, plan to invite a subcommittee to one of the available training workshops we will be leading this semester and next.)

Presentation Materials

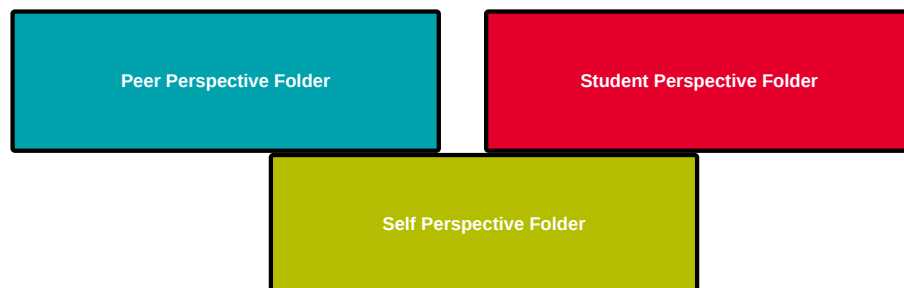
Deep Dive Into New Practices Slides



The screenshot shows a Google Slides presentation. The slide is titled "2024-2025 CAT" and "Meeting 7: Deep Dive into New Practices". It features logos for "ie3 inclusive excellence" and "DeLTA UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA". The date "November, 2024" and "PAGE 01" are visible at the bottom of the slide content. The Google Slides interface at the bottom shows a navigation bar with a back arrow, a "1" in a circle, a forward arrow, and a menu icon, along with a "Google Slides" logo.

[Link to Slides](#)

Resources



Post-Meeting Assignment

- None this week!

2.8: Meeting 7- Deep Dive Into New Practices is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

Pilot Testing New Practices

Objectives

- Create a plan to find and adapt specific materials for revising teaching evaluation.
- Review resources, collaborate, draft documents to pilot in the next semester.

Presentation Materials

Pilot Testing New Practices Slides

2024-2025 CAT

Meeting 8:
Planning for Pilot
New Practices



December, 2024

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 Google Slides

[Link to Slides](#)

Post-Meeting Assignment

- TBA!

[Submission Folder](#)

2.9: Meeting 8- Pilot Testing New Practices is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

Final CAT/LAT Meeting 2025

Objectives

- Celebrate the changes in teaching evaluation practices that your department has achieved over the past year.
- Determine what your department hopes to accomplish by the end of the next academic year related to teaching evaluation.

Presentation Materials

[Final CAT/LAT Meeting Slides](#)

2024-2025 CAT

Final CAT/LAT Meeting 2025



May 2025

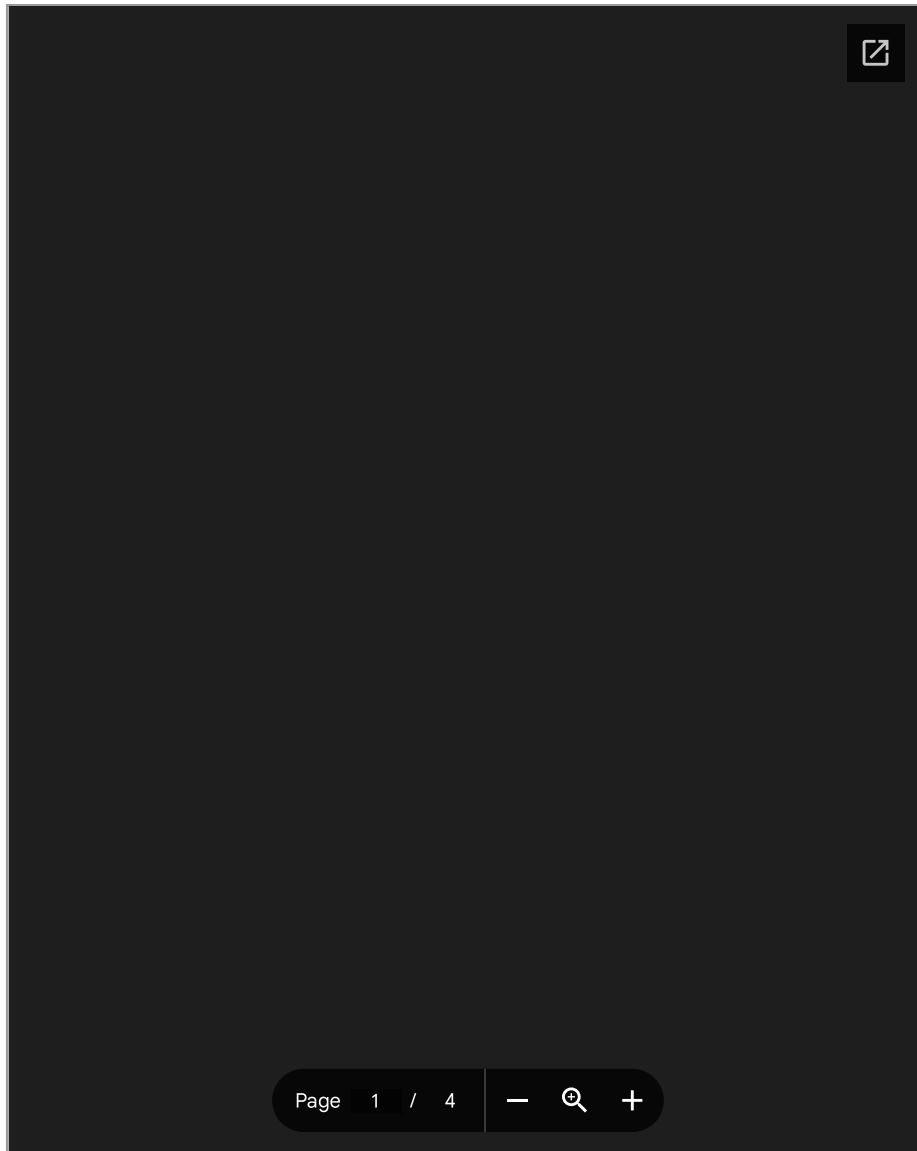
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 Google Slides

[Link to Slides](#)

[2024-2025 DeLTA Cohort Accomplishments Handout](#)



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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Leadership Action Team Page

3.1: 2.0 Fall 2024 Meeting Schedule

3.2: Meeting 1- Prepare for Action

3.3: Meeting 2- Understand the Three Voices

3.4: Meetings 3 and 4- Assess Current Practices

3.5: Meeting 5- Prepare to Lead Change

3.6: Final CAT/LAT Meeting

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3.1: 2.0 Fall 2024 Meeting Schedule

Date	CAT	LAT
August	Onboarding and reflecting on teaching eval practices <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 8/26, Tues 8/27, Wed 8/28</i>	Onboarding and reflecting on teaching eval practices <i>Meeting Date: Mon 8/26</i>
September	Three voices framework for teaching evaluation <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 9/9, Tues 9/10, Wed 9/11</i>	Three voices framework for teaching evaluation <i>Meeting Date: Mon 9/16</i>
September	Self-assessment of departmental teaching evaluation practices (GATES) <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 9/23, Tues 9/24, Wed 9/25</i>	
October	Leadership development - building buy-in for new dept teaching practices <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 10/7, Tues 10/8, Wed 10/9</i>	Self-assessment of departmental teaching evaluation practices (GATES), peer voice <i>Meeting Date: Fri 10/18</i>
October	Developing new practices, e.g., peer observation <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 10/21, Tues 10/22, Wed 10/23</i>	
November	1-on-1 meeting between Heads & CAT members for each unit <i>This week is free-time to meet with department heads, no CAT meetings!</i>	Self-assessment of departmental teaching evaluation practices (GATES), student and self voice <i>Meeting Date: Fri 11/15</i>
November	Developing new practices, e.g., instructor self-reflection <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 11/18, Tues 11/19, Wed 11/20</i>	
December	Planning for pilot testing new practices <i>Meeting Dates: Mon 12/2, Tues 12/3, Wed 12/4</i>	Building buy-in for new dept teaching practices <i>Meeting Date: Wed 12/11</i>

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Prepare for Action: Reflecting on Current Teaching Evaluation Practices

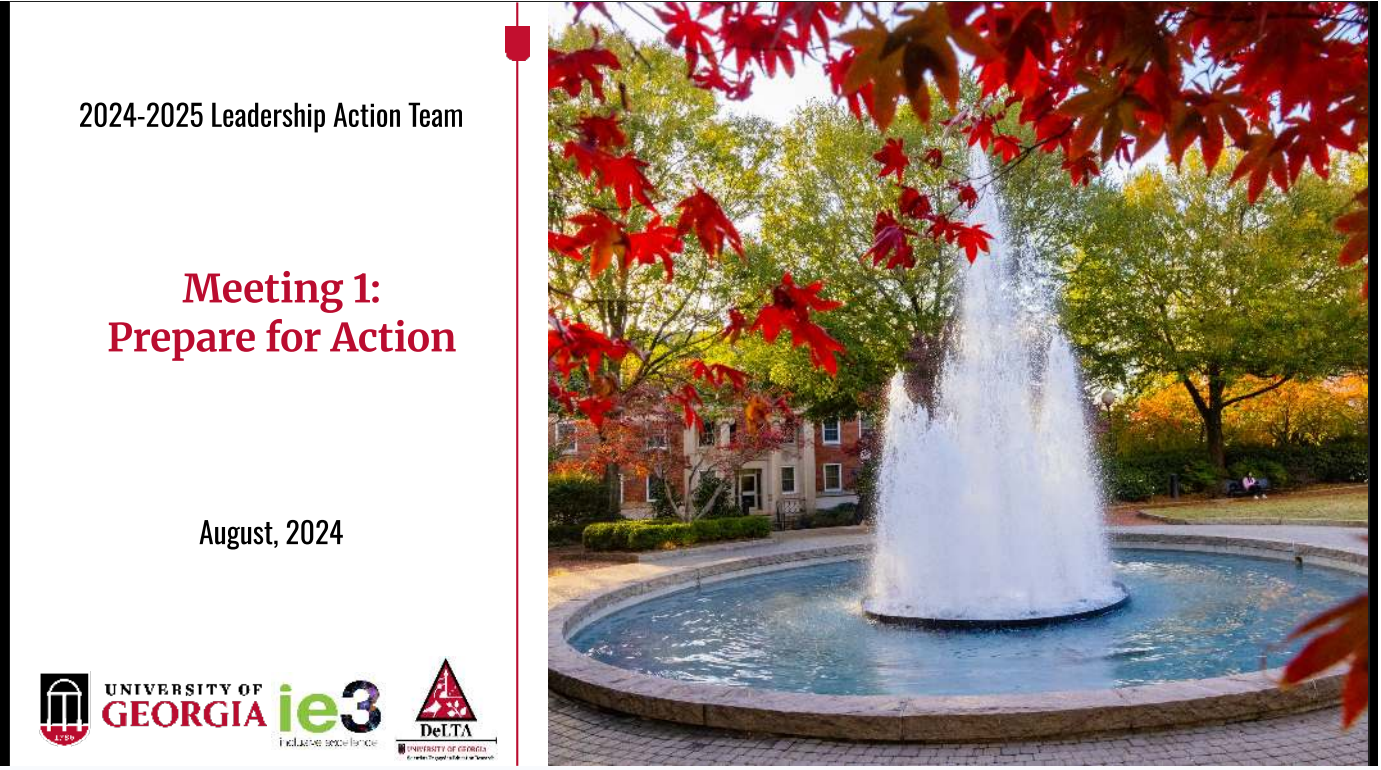
Goals

- Get to know each other and your academic units.
- Exchange information about the needs and challenges in your units when it comes to teaching evaluation.

The first step for LAT members is to *prepare for action* by familiarizing themselves with the expected outcomes of participation and reflecting on what a department can learn from effective teaching evaluation, and what the department's current teaching evaluation practices are. On this page you will find key points and takeaways from the first meeting and a link to materials used and discussed during the meeting.

Presentation Materials

[Prepare for Action Slides](#)

[Link to Slides](#)

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Understand the Three Voices

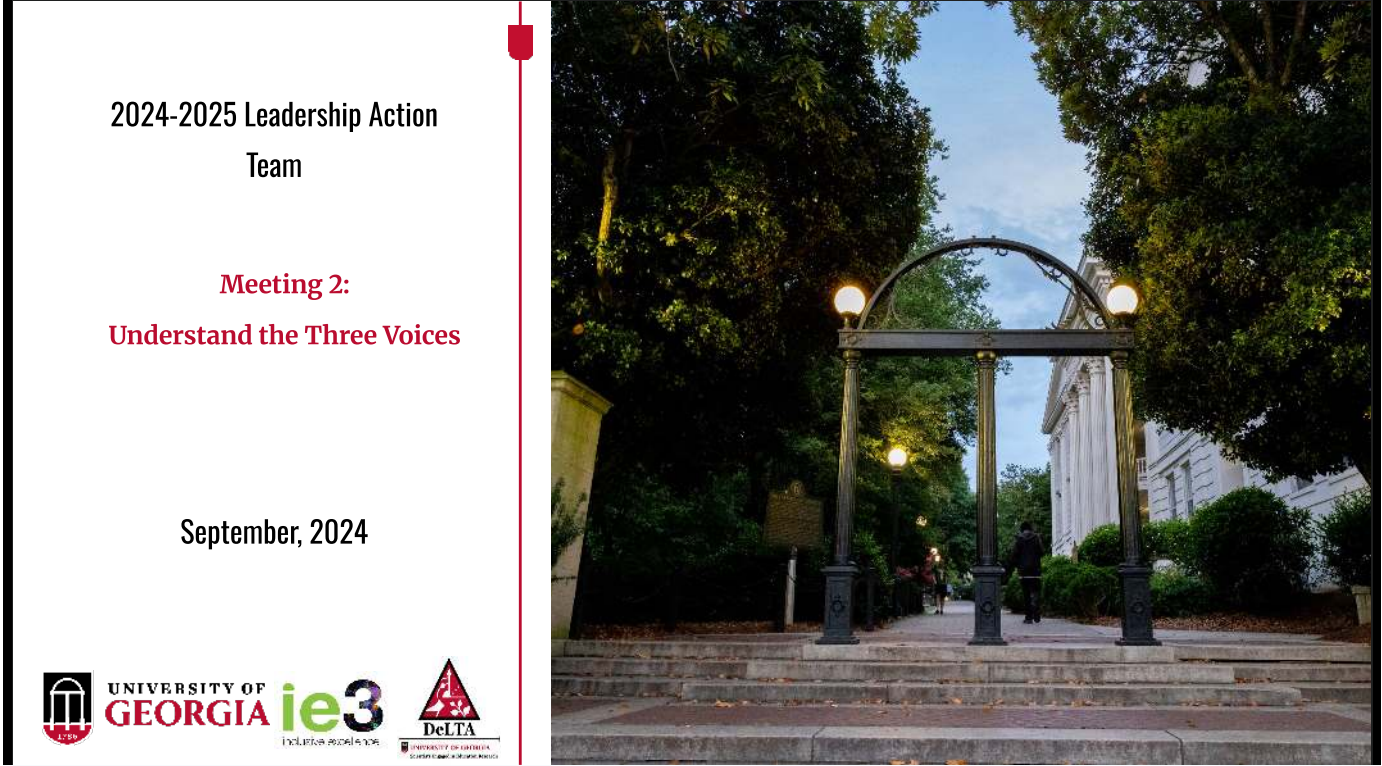
Goals

- Critically consider the utility and feasibility of evaluating teaching via students, peers, and self-reflection.
- Prepare for (1) self-assessment of teaching evaluation practices (October & November meetings) and (2) one-on-one meetings with CAT members (November)

DeLTA draws upon the three-voice framework for teaching evaluation (<https://teval.net/>; National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine 2020). This framework points out that effective teaching evaluation depends upon input from students, peers, and the instructor. Thus, the second step is for LAT members to understand the three-voice framework conceptually and to see the opportunities and challenges with gathering feedback on teaching from each voice. On this page you will find key points and takeaways from the second meeting, links to materials used and discussed during the meeting, and the reflection assignment.

Presentation Materials

[Understand the Three Voices Slides](#)



2024-2025 Leadership Action Team

Meeting 2:
Understand the Three Voices

September, 2024

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Google Slides

[Link to Slides](#)

[Common Issues with Evaluating Teaching White Paper](#)



Issues with Evaluating Teaching

Peer Voice

Peer voice involves gathering data from peers about teaching and learning observable in class. Peer observation often includes:

- Pre-observation meeting to discuss lessons to be observed
- Collection & review of class materials (e.g., syllabi, exams, homework, slides, handouts)
- Observation of lessons
- Post-observation meeting to hear instructor reflections, debrief, and provide feedback

Peer voice can provide feedback and evidence of effectiveness on components that are better assessed by peers than by students, such as appropriateness of course material and course difficulty, alignment with the larger curriculum, and effectiveness of teaching strategies (Berstein 2008; Peel 2005). Studies examining peer review have documented several positive outcomes for faculty involved in the process, including improved self-assurance (Bell and Mladenovic 2008), collegiality and respect (Quinlan and Akerlind 2000), and improved classroom performance (Freiberg 1987). UGA expects departments to establish a peer evaluation process for full-time faculty in order to support teaching improvement over time and document teaching effectiveness fairly and equitably.

Issues with Peer Evaluation

- **Lack of focus on growth:** Peer reviews are often conducted as one-shot events and therefore fail to capture growth and change over time. They also do not provide opportunities for reflection (Peel 2005) or to collaboratively construct solutions with peers (Quinlan and Akerlind 2000) that are needed to achieve changes in teaching quality (Brockbank and McGill 1998).
- **Lack of consistency:** Without preliminary discussion of what effective teaching entails, individual evaluators differ widely in the evaluations and comments that they provide as peer reviewers (Centra, 1975) and tend to base their evaluations on the extent to which the style of the instructor matches their own style (Centra, 2000). A structured approach involving a standard form and observer training can improve consistency and the value of the feedback provided.
- **Concerns about who has the expertise to review:** Faculty may be skeptical of the utility of feedback they might receive from colleagues outside their field (Bell & Mladenovic, 2008). Alternatively, they may feel that colleagues in their department lack pedagogical knowledge to evaluate their teaching.
- **Time:** Faculty may be concerned about expansion of their roles/time expectations for peer review of teaching (Atwood, Taylor, & Hutchings, 2000; Chism, 2007; Kell & Annetts, 2009).
- **Worry that review will be demoralizing:** Faculty are sensitive to receiving constructive feedback, perceiving it as discouraging unless put in perspective (Cosh, 1998; Donnelly, 2007).
- **Evaluators need training:** Several authors have emphasized the need to better train feedback providers (Shortland, 2010), but there are few models for how to provide this training. Faculty feel unprepared to judge the quality of teaching (Cohen & McKeachie, 1980; Kremer, 1990).

Assess Current Practices

Goals

- Self-assess your department's teaching evaluation practices.
- Prepare for one-on-one meeting with CAT member in November.

Having understood the three-voice framework, LAT members are ready to begin assessing their department's teaching evaluation practices with this lens. Each LAT member in this meeting picks a voice to focus on (e.g., peer or student) and goes through a guided reflection on the presence or absence of evidence-based, improvement-oriented, and equity-centered teaching evaluation practices for that voice in their department. On this page you will find key points and takeaways from the third meeting, links to materials used and discussed during the meeting, and the reflection assignment. Note that this page describes two meetings as LAT members need two, one-hour sessions to fully reflect on each voice.

Presentation Materials

[Assess Current Practices Slides](#)



The screenshot shows a Google Slides presentation. The slide content includes:

- 2024-2025 Leadership Action Team**
- Meeting 3 & 4:**
- Assess Current Practices**
- October, 2024**
- November, 2024**

At the bottom of the slide are logos for the University of Georgia, ie3, and DeLTA. To the right of the text is a photograph of a person wearing a face shield and using a power tool on a sculpture. The Google Slides interface at the bottom shows a navigation bar with a '1' and a 'Google Slides' icon.

[Link to Slides](#)

The Peer Perspective from UGA's Center for Teaching and Learning Website



- [Contact Us](#)

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Upcoming Events

Apr 23

[Closing Out the Semester with eLC Essentials](#)

11:30 AM - 12:30 PM

Apr 27

Peer Perspective from the GATES



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Prepare to Lead Change

Goals

- Critically consider the new teaching evaluation practices you and your CAT members will lead your department to pilot.
- Anticipate the problems these new practices will solve.
- Anticipate the challenges you may run into and the evidence that these will be the challenges.
- Strategize about leveraging the problem solving and navigating around the challenges.

Having self-assessed departmental teaching evaluation practices and met with the CAT members from the unit, LAT/CAT members have likely decided what new teaching evaluation practices they want to pilot in the coming year. Each LAT member in this meeting will be asked to think critically about the problems these new practices will solve and for whom (i.e., different faculty are interested in different problems that the new practice may address) as well as the issues they expect to run into when implementing the pilot. Then they will be encouraged to strategize how to leverage the opportunities for problem solving and work around the challenges. LAT members should leave with ideas of how to turn the pilot into some wins - even if small ones.

Presentation Materials

[Prepare to Lead Change Slides](#)



2024-2025 Leadership Action Team

Meeting 5:
Prepare to Lead Change

December, 2024

UNIVERSITY OF GEORGIA ie3 DeLTA

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Google Slides

[Link to Slides](#)

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Final CAT/LAT Meeting 2025

Objectives

- Celebrate the changes in teaching evaluation practices that your department has achieved over the past year.
- Determine what your department hopes to accomplish by the end of the next academic year related to teaching evaluation.

Presentation Materials

[Final CAT/LAT Meeting Slides](#)

2024-2025 CAT

Final CAT/LAT Meeting 2025



May 2025

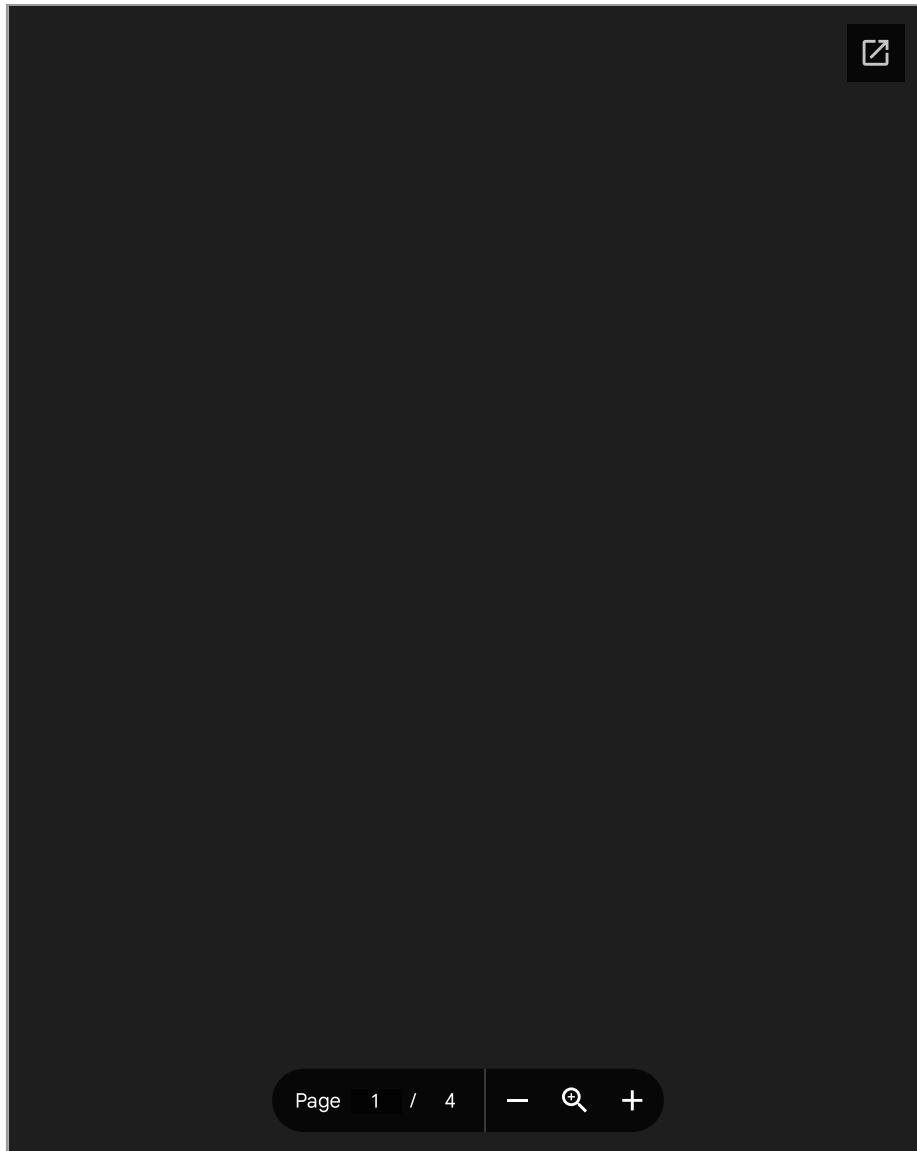
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 Google Slides

[Link to Slides](#)

[2024-2025 DeLTA Cohort Accomplishments Handout](#)



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Index

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Glossary

Sample Word 1 | Sample Definition 1

Detailed Licensing

Overview

Title: DeLTA Teaching Evaluation Learning Community

Webpages: 41

All licenses found:

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By Page

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